BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES 8_NOVEMBER_2026

No. 54 ~ THIRTY-SECOND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF
31 Sixtowns Road
Telephone: 79628376
Email:ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 79632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street
Phone: (028)79628248
Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught
Phone: (028)79397047
Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**
Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:
Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org
Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
  - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
  - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
  - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.
www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.



NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

Email: **desertmartinparish@gmail.com**

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm

St Patrick's, Keenaught: **4.30 pm - NB New Time**

SUNDAY MASSES

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 9 November

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary - Mass in honour of Padre Pio.

Tuesday ~ 10 November

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

Wednesday ~ 11 November

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Thursday ~ 12 November

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

Friday ~ 13 November

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary Church.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary at 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass on Saturday.

Desertmartin: St. Patrick's, Keenaught at 4.00 pm - before Vigil Mass on Saturday.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Monday 9 November: The Dedication of The Lateran Basilica.

Tuesday 10 November: St Leo the Great.

Wednesday 11 November: St Martin of Tours

Thursday 12 November: St Josaphat

Friday 13 November: St Laurence O'Toole

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20. Prayers for the happy repose of the souls of the recently deceased members and all deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society will take place at the Masses on the weekends of 7/8 November and 14/15 November.

MASS IN HONOUR OF PADRE PIO

The monthly mass in honour of St. Pio of Pietrelcina will be celebrated on Monday 9 November at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church. Novena prayers and rosary at 7.00 pm. Adoration from 12 noon until 7.30 pm.

ANNUAL MASS FOR DECEASED PARISHIONERS

- Tuesday 17 November at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.
- Wednesday 18 November at 7.30 pm in St Patrick's Keenaught.

The names of all who died or were buried in our parish since last year's Parish Mass of Remembrance will be read out at this Mass. After all the names have been read out, a member of each of these bereaved families, will be invited to carry a lit candle to the altar. Each family should ensure that an adult has been selected to represent them. Candles will be provided at the back of the church during this Mass.

CHANGE OF MASS TIME

The Anniversary Mass on **Friday 20 November in Holy Rosary Church, will be held at the earlier time of 7.00 pm**, this schedule adjustment has been made to accommodate the town's Christmas lights switch-on event occurring the same evening.

MONTH'S MIND MASS

The Month's Mind Mass for Jacinta McEldowney, will take place on Saturday 14 November in St Patrick's Church, Keenaught at 4.30 pm.
The Month's Mind Mass for Terrence Hegarty, Ranaghan Road, will take place on Friday 20 November at 7.00 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for Brigid O'Neill, née Burke, Magherafelt will be held on Friday 20 November at 7.00 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

Annie Kelly, Mallon Villas;
Victor Lynn, Cordarragh;
Josephine Trainor, Moneyneena Rd.;
Marie Mullen, Glenshane Park;
Margaret McBride, Campbelltown Terrace.

Desertmartin:

Rose O'Hagan;
Selina O'Hagan;
Jimmy Lyttle;
Jim McIvor;
Gerry Murray;
Nellie Trainor;
Anne McGuigan;
Rosie Donnelly.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Jude Thomas Glasgow, Cahore Terrace;
Nora Sarah Conlon & Conall Patrick Conlon, Brackaghislea Road.

PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES WITH BISHOP MICHAEL ROUTER

Led by Bishop Michael Router. There are two options available as follows:

Option 1: 8 - 13 July, 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to Assisted Pilgrims and family members, Care Team, Youth, Youth Leaders and Priests.

Option 2: 7 - 14 July, 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport. Single Supplement and Travel Insurance will be extra. Expressions of Interest can be emailed to derrypilgrim@outlook.com. Bookings will begin in mid-January, with more details later. Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers of any value are available from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop Street, Derry, for anyone wishing to purchase them, particularly as a Christmas Gift. Please contact 028 7136 2475 for further information.

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

Fully escorted group to Fatima accompanied by Spiritual Director, 28 June – 5 July 2027. Direct Daytime Flights Belfast to Porto return. Staying in 4* Hotel. Full Board. Services of JWT Pilgrimage Guide. Daily Mass & Spiritual Activities. Cost £975pps. Early Booking Offer: £100 OFF if Paid In Full by 30 November 2026. Further details contact Christina Lagan 07803192621

SHRINES OF FRANCE PILGRIMAGE

Lisieux, Rue Du Bac, Nevers, Paris, Rocamadour and Lourdes - fully escorted pilgrimage from 11 to 18 June 2027. 7 Nights flying from Dublin to Paris/Lourdes to Dublin. Including visits to the home of the Miraculous Medal, and to see the incorrupt bodies of St Catherine Laboure and St Bernadette. In Paris visit Sacre-Coeur, Lourdes, plus much more. Comprehensive Travel insurance is **extra** £35.00. Cost: £1,200 **per person sharing. Places are limited**. Single room supplement is £345.00 **extra**. Spiritual Director: Fr Joe McGuigan. £250.00 deposit secures a seat! For further details contact: Jean Reynolds 07729 402311 or Email: jeanreynolds@hotmail.co.uk

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £3547.80

Renovation Collection - £2468.50

Mission Collection - £81.50 (Total: £1592.65)

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1183.20

Renovation Collection - £686.20

Mission Collection - £145

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

Totals shown include October Standing Orders from Parishioners. If would like to avail of this option please contact the Parish Office.

CHOIR DIRECTOR: ST EUGENE'S CATHEDRAL, DERRY

10 hours per week: St Eugene's Cathedral is recruiting for an experienced choir director to lead and manage all aspects of the cathedral choir. They will ensure that the music enhances worship services and aligns with the church's liturgical themes. For a job description and application pack - Tel.: (028) 7126 2302 or Email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Submit completed applications to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP, or Email to: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Applications to be received by noon on Thursday 12 November 2026.

DERRY DIOCESE VOCATIONS

There will be a meeting for anyone considering a vocation to the diocesan priesthood, in Derry, on Sunday 8 November, beginning at 4.00 pm. For further details, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan - Email: pgoh2111@gmail.com or Tel.: (028) 79386259.

TROCAIRE IS LOOKING FOR VOLUNTEERS

To help deliver school talks during our annual Lent Appeal during **February and March 2027.** We are particularly interested in hearing from people with public speaking experience, especially retired teachers or those who have worked with young people. Volunteers will visit local schools during school hours to share stories of hope, justice and solidarity from communities around the world. The role involves approximately **1-2 short talks per week** during the four-month campaign period. Full training, presentation materials and ongoing support will be provided. Please contact Fionnuala McGuinness on 028 9080 8033 or fionnuala.mcguinness@trocaire.org by the first week of December if you are interested!

WARM WELCOME WEDNESDAY

In Workspace Community Hub, Wednesday 11 November from 11.00 am to 1.00 pm. We will be joined by Inspire Wellbeing at 11.45 am for a mental health and wellbeing session. Inspire Wellbeing is an all-island charity focused on mental health, intellectual disabilities and addiction support. This session provides participants with an opportunity to consider what we really mean by 'mental health' and how we can look after our mental health and strengthen our overall wellbeing. Booking not required, just drop in on the day. Free tea, coffee and refreshments also served.

HAEMOCHROMATOSIS COFFEE EVENING

Free event, for anyone who suffers with haemochromatosis, waiting on diagnoses or family & friends, to learn more & support one another. Neil from haemochromatosis UK will be in attendance, to answer questions & offer advice & guidance. Venue: The Community Hub (next to library), Draperstown on Wednesday 11 November from 6.30 pm to 8.00 pm. All welcome.

ABIDE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE 2026

20 - 22 November. Join hundreds of women at the **Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran,** Speakers include Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Kimberlee Woo Ling, Fr Oisín Martin CFR, Fr Barry Braum, the Nashville Dominican Sisters, Fr David Nugent and Fr Mark Wharton, with Holy Mass celebrated by Bishop Fintan Gavin. A weekend of **faith, celebration, healing and joy! Register on Eventbrite: Abide in His Love.**

FREE STRESS CONTROL CLASSES

The classes are **FREE** and the next round will commence on **Monday 9 November at 9.00 am**, with session two on the following Monday at 9.00 am (**16 November**). Access the online classes at https://ni.stresscontrol.org/.

RANGANNA GAEILGE / IRISH LANGUAGE CLASSES

Join a growing community to learn Irish in a fun, welcoming environment! A New Christmas Themed 6-week course is starting on Monday 9 November in St Mary's Hall, Desertmartin, wrapping up with a festive *Céili Na Nollaig* (Christmas Céili) in the pub during Christmas week.

Bunrang (Beginners): 6:45pm – 8.00 pm.

Meanrang (Improvers): 8.00 pm – 9:30 pm

Spaces are limited. To book a place - Email: **knocknaginhc@gmail.com**, or Tel.: Edward **07835161927** / Gerard **02879631744**.

KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Craft Fair: Today, Sunday 8 November from 10:30 am to 3.00 pm. Santa will visit from 11.00 am to 2.00 pm! Bring the children along to meet Santa and get into the Christmas spirit! Over 25 stalls from all over Mid-Ulster packed with handmade goodies, festive decorations and so much more — there's something for everyone!

Social Tea Dance: Friday 13 November at 9.00 pm. Music by Kenny Paul. Adm £7 - includes refreshments. Everyone welcome

Céilí & Salsa Dancing Lessons have now finished.

SARSFIELD'S ACCORDION BAND.

Band practice on Thursday evenings at 7:30pm. New and past members are welcome to come along.

SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP

Indoor Bowls: Mondays at 8.15 pm. New Members Welcome.

Christmas Fair with Santa: Sunday 29 November 2026 at Sixtowns Hall. Tables are booking up fast. £20 per table or £30 for two. To book Tel.: 07769 289385

Social Dance Classes every Tuesday night at 8.30 pm. All Welcome.

GAELSCOIL & NAÍSCOIL NA SPEIRÍNÍ - OPEN AFTERNOON

Sunday 15 November from 1.00 pm to 3.00 pm. Parents and children who are ready for Primary 1 and Nursery in September 2027 are very welcome to visit the school and meet with staff and pupils. Fun Activities for all. Santa Claus will be there to meet all the children too.

BINGO FOR BALI

Join us for an evening of fun bingo, laughter and great prizes as we raise funds for occupational therapy equipment for underprivileged children in Bali. Saturday 14 November in An Ráth Dubh, Moneyneany. Doors open at 7.00 pm, eyes down at 7:30 pm. Tickets £15, available at Centra, Draperstown; Heron's Chemist; or Spar, Tobermore. Or contact Katie at 07834276636 or Amy on 07517079916. All support greatly appreciated!

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

29 November, Holy Rosary Church.
6 December, St. Patrick's, Sixtowns.
13 December, St. Columba's, Straw.
20 December, St Eugene's Moneyneena.
27 December, Holy Rosary Church.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

November 22 2026
December 6 & 20 2026
January 10 & 24 2027
February 7 & 21 2027
March 7 & 14 2027
April 4 & 18 2027

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to **ballinascreenparish@gmail.com**

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come.

St Ergnat's GAC: Winter Wellbeing Event Sat 28th November 10am-1.30pm : Men's Health Check Bus, Cooking Demos, a chance to try out activities available in the community. **Booking for bus essential @ 07515 954734**

Ceili Class every Thursday night 7-9.30pm in the Open Door Complex. Everyone welcome.

"The Long Now" a staged reading by "Off the Cuff" on 13 Nov at 7.30pm In Seamus Heaney Homeplace. Admission £10.

St John Bosco Primary School Open Morning for children due to start primary school in September 2027 will be held on Tues 1 Dec from 9:30-10:30 am
We look forward to welcoming prospective parents to our school. Our new pupils will have their own special Induction Morning in June.

St Mary's PS, Greenlough – Open Day, Thursday 3 December, 3.30 – 5.30pm. Parents of prospective pupils are welcome to come along, explore the school, and meet the team. Email: www.stmaryspsgreenlough.com Tel: (028) 25821066.

Derry Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lourdes 2027, under the leadership of Bishop Michael Router.
Option 1 – 7-14 July – 7 nights, £1,095, from Belfast International Airport.
Option 2 – 8-13 July – 5 nights, £980, from City of Derry Airport, with priority given to pilgrims requiring assistance, and to their family members, Care Team, and Youth, and Youth Leaders. There will be a Single Supplement. Travel Insurance will be an additional cost. Expressions of interest should be emailed to: derrypilgrim@outlook.com Bookings will begin in mid-January. **Pilgrimage Gift Vouchers,** (maybe a Christmas gift idea), of any value, are available to purchase from the Pastoral Centre, Bishop St, Derry**. Tel: (028) 71362475** for further information.

Greenlough Parish Office is closed until further notice, but is contactable by phone on (028) 25821190, or by email: greenloughparish@gmail.com
Website: www.greenloughparish.com
Bellaghy Parish Office: Monday, Wednesday, Thursday, 9am – 3pm;
Friday, 8-11am. Tel: (028) 79386259 or email: info@bellaghyparish.com
Website: www.bellaghyparish.com Please note: the office is closed on Tuesdays.

St Mary's, Bellaghy / St Joseph's, Ballyscullion
St Oliver Plunkett, Clady
8 November 2026 – 32nd Sunday of the Year

Eucharistic Adoration. As mentioned recently, we hope to renew or reawaken Adoration of Jesus in the Blessed Sacrament in our parishes. We will welcome guest speakers to our parishes, next weekend, 14/15 November.
Anyone interested in helping in any way is invited to a meeting in the Quiet Room of St Oliver Plunkett Church, Clady, at 6.45pm on Tues 10 November, and to a follow-up meeting in the St Carlo Acutis Adoration Chapel, Bellaghy, at 7pm, on Mon 16 Nov. Volunteers will be needed to assist with the distribution of forms at the weekend Masses of 14/15 Nov. **If you would like to help, please contact either parish office**.



During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come. Let us continues to pray for those whom the Lord is calling to serve this diocese as priests, that as they discern their future, they will be open to the possibility of priesthood.

This week's diary:
Mon 9 – Bellaghy - Mass at 9.30am
Tues 10 – Greenlough, - Mass at 9.30am. Rosary at 7.30pm.
Wed 11 – Bellaghy - Mass at 9.30am
Thurs 12 – Greenlough – Adoration, 9am – 5pm
Friday 13 – Greenlough – Mass at 9.30am. **Service for the Dead, 7pm**.
Friday 13 – Bellaghy – Adoration, 10am – 8pm (Rosary at 7.30pm)
Sat, 5.30pm (Streamed from Greenlough) **Sun, 11am** (Streamed to Greenlough)
Sun 15 – Ballyscullion – Mass at 9.45am

Fr Pat hopes to visit the **Sick and Housebound as follows:** Monday – Bellaghy C (Ballynease area); Friday – Greenlough B (Mayogall Road, Ballymacpeake Road, Mullanamoyagh Road.

Baptism Dates – November & December 2026; January 2027
Bellaghy at 1pm – 5 December; 9 January
Greenlough at 4.15pm – 28 November; 19 December; 30 January.

Deaths: We pray for the families and friends of **Fr Philip, OCSO, Portglenone,** and **Danny Cassidy, Coleraine,** who died recently.

Anniversaries: **Sat/Sun 7/8:** 5.30pm (Anniversary Mass for James Toner, Barney and Rose McErlean), Bernie McIvor (Anniversary Mass at 11am), Eamon Ferris, Siobhan McErlean, Peter Kealey, Thomas Mullan, Jane Scullion, Dessie Diamond, Sinead McLarnon, Agnes McPeake, Elisha McCann, Paddy McCann, Jim McTeague, Mary Ann McLaughlin, Philomena Tohill, Jim McDonnell, Margaret Doherty, James McErlean, Mary Toner, John Lee, Rose Agnew, James O'Loughlin, Jim O'Loughlin, Des Diamond, Marion Devlin

Sat/Sun 14/15: Anthony Diamond (Month's Mind at 11am), Peggy Larkin (Month's Mind at 11am), Barney McCallion,

May they rest in peace.

ST. MALACHY'S G.A.C. – Lotto Nos 1 3 17 22 drawn Monday 2nd Nov . No winner. £25 each to Roger Lennox and Noel Cosgrove. Jackpot £700 next week.

St Ergnats lotto results for 3/11/26. 2,8,23,25. No winner. £30 each to Eileen Kerr and Sean Boyd. Jackpot now £1,450.

Bellaghy GAA Lotto No's 10,16, 21, 22. No jackpot winner. £25 each to Cathal McErlean & Tracey Downey. Next week's jackpot: £4700.

From St Columba to Sr Clare Crockett – Discover 1500 years of Faith and Culture at Long Tower Church, Derry. **Áras Cholmcille – St Columba's Museum, and Sr Clare Exhibition.** Also, take a **guided tour of the Church And Museum** (with lunch). **Tour, Lunch and Talk** (on Mondays and Tuesdays) at St Columba's Heritage Centre. For booking or further information, please email stcolumbatours@outlook.com

Called to Serve – A Day of Support and Inspiration for Parish Ministry will take place in Knock on Saturday 21 November, 10am – 3pm, for anyone already involved, or interested in getting involved, in any aspect of parish ministry – Readers, Eucharistic Ministers, Music, Youth Ministry, Welcome/ Ushers, Flower arranging. For further information, please contact Nicola Mitchell at nicolamitchell@knockshrine.ie Please contact either parish office if you're interested in attending.

All three Churches in the Parishes of Bellaghy and Greenlough will have a Box or Book available in which you can put the names of those you wish to be remembered in our prayers during the month of the Holy Souls (November).



EVERYONE MATTERS SEN GROUP is having a fundraising **Bring & Buy** in The Open Door Complex, Bellaghy, next Sunday, 15 November, from 1.30 – 4.30pm. Bring along any unwanted items, including books, bric-a-brac, clothes, homeware, toys… Sellers' tables cost £15 each. Email the group at: everyonemattersbellaghy@gmail.com

TRÓCAIRE is looking for volunteers to help deliver talks in schools during their annual Lenten Appeal, during February and March next year. They are particularly interested in hearing from people with public speaking experience, retired teachers, or anyone who has worked with young people. Volunteers will work during school hours, sharing stories of justice, hope, and solidarity from communities around the world. Full training, presentation materials, and ongoing support will be provided. If interested, please contact Fionnuala McGuinness on (028) 90808033 or email: fionnuala.mcguinness@trocaire.org by the first week in December.

Any outstanding payments of £26 for the **Messenger Magazine** should be returned to the sacristies of any of the churches, or to the Parish Office in Bellaghy, as soon as possible, please.

We welcome the **Rise & Shine Pilgrimage Trust** to our parishes this weekend, to deliver their annual appeal for financial aid towards next year's Pilgrimage to Lourdes with young people with additional needs. After this weekend donations can be left at any of the churches, Bellaghy Parish Office, or at the Pharmacy in Bellaghy

Please note: Anniversary Notices should be left at either parish office by noon on Wednesdays. From now on, any names received after this deadline will be held over to the following weekend.